



snow-covered mountains of the Zaskar Range. It is an immense mountain glacier 14 miles (23 km) long, with an average thickness of 490 ft (150 m), which feeds the Doda (or Stod) River, and so is important for irrigating the fertile farmland downslope.

The Rongbuk Glacier

Location Southern Tibet, China

Two tributary glaciers (the East and West Rongbuk) converge to form one flow of ice that is 14 miles (22 km) long—a fine example of a valley glacier moving north from Mount Everest onto the Tibetan Plateau. Climbers have used East Rongbuk’s impressive medial moraine as a way to access Everest’s North Col, describing it as the “magic highway.” On either side of the moraine, the ice has been churned into fields of seracs (towering, jagged ice pinnacles)—some up to 100 ft (30 m) high—with ice bridges and pillars adding to the chaotic impression.

Other glaciers and ice sheets in Asia

- The Baltoro Glacier » p.233
- The Biafo Glacier » p.234
- The Fedchenko Glacier » p.232
- The Khumbu Glacier » p.235
- The Yulong Glacier » p.232

Australia and New Zealand

The Fox Glacier

Location The Southern Alps of South Island, New Zealand

Fed by four alpine glaciers, this heavily crevassed maritime glacier plunges down 8,500 ft (2,600 m) over the course of its 8-mile (13-km) flow from Mount Tasman to the coast of New Zealand’s South Island. Its outflow, 980 ft (300 m) above sea level, is the Fox River, and it is one of the few glaciers to terminate in lush temperate rain forest. Its recent history of advance and retreat is fascinating. During the last ice age, it extended beyond the present coastline, since which time it has retreated a long way. Between 1985 and 2009, it advanced again, sometimes rapidly, but since then the retreat has continued.

Other glaciers and ice sheets in Australia and New Zealand

- The Franz Josef Glacier » p.280
- The Tasman Glacier » p.281

up to 394 in (10,000 mm) and avalanches in an environment where winter temperatures may plunge to -58°F (-50°C).

The Kolahoi Glacier

Location Jammu and Kashmir state, India

Below the pyramidal rock mass of Kolahoi Peak, this glacier flows from an icefield that also feeds three other glaciers. Kolahoi, which is the source of the Lidder River, has an average elevation of 15,400 ft (4,700 m). Between

1963 and 2005, its area contracted from 5 square miles (14 square km) to 4 square miles (11 square km), and it is still retreating at the rate of 10 ft (3 m) a year. The interior of the glacier is believed to be hollowing out.

Durung Drung

Location Jammu and Kashmir state, India

One of the most beautiful Himalayan glaciers, Durung Drung is a gently meandering stream of ice flowing between the towering,

▼ CREVASSES IN THE FOX GLACIER

